

CoE and Data @ EBRD launch event

Prathy Kamasani

Data Nova · Microsoft MVP

Starting Right

Building a governance foundation for Fabric and Power BI

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WHO'S TALKING

Prathy Kamasani

Microsoft Data Platform MVP · Solopreneur · Data Nova

- Consulting on Microsoft Fabric and Power BI
- Design First: architecture and governance from day one
- Runs the London Microsoft Fabric User Group

You're launching COE

CoE is the decision to do analytics deliberately rather than by accident

Fabric

Where data is stored, prepared and served.

Power BI

See and explore the numbers.

Analytics

Turning that data into decisions.

One agreed version of the numbers.

Not five spreadsheets that disagree.

And soon, not five AI agents that disagree.

A single source of truth doesn't happen on its own

Discipline at the core, flexibility at the edge.

Define it. Endorse it. Keep defending it.

What happens without it

- **Duplicated models.**
- **Numbers no one trusts.**
- **A security surface no one can see.**

MICROSOFT, BEFORE ITS OWN COE

75% of analysts' time spent collecting and compiling data

78% of reports built in offline environments

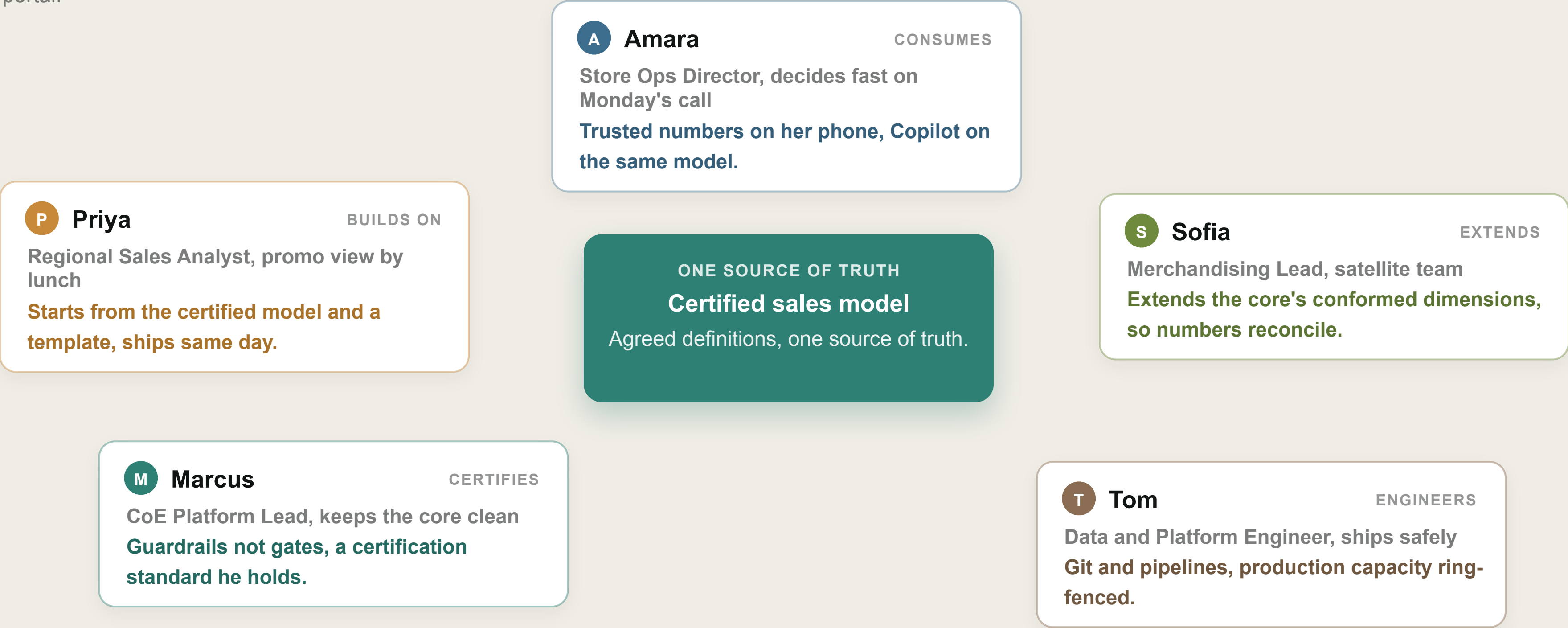
350+ centralised finance tools

~\$30m a year on shadow applications

Every region defining revenue its own way

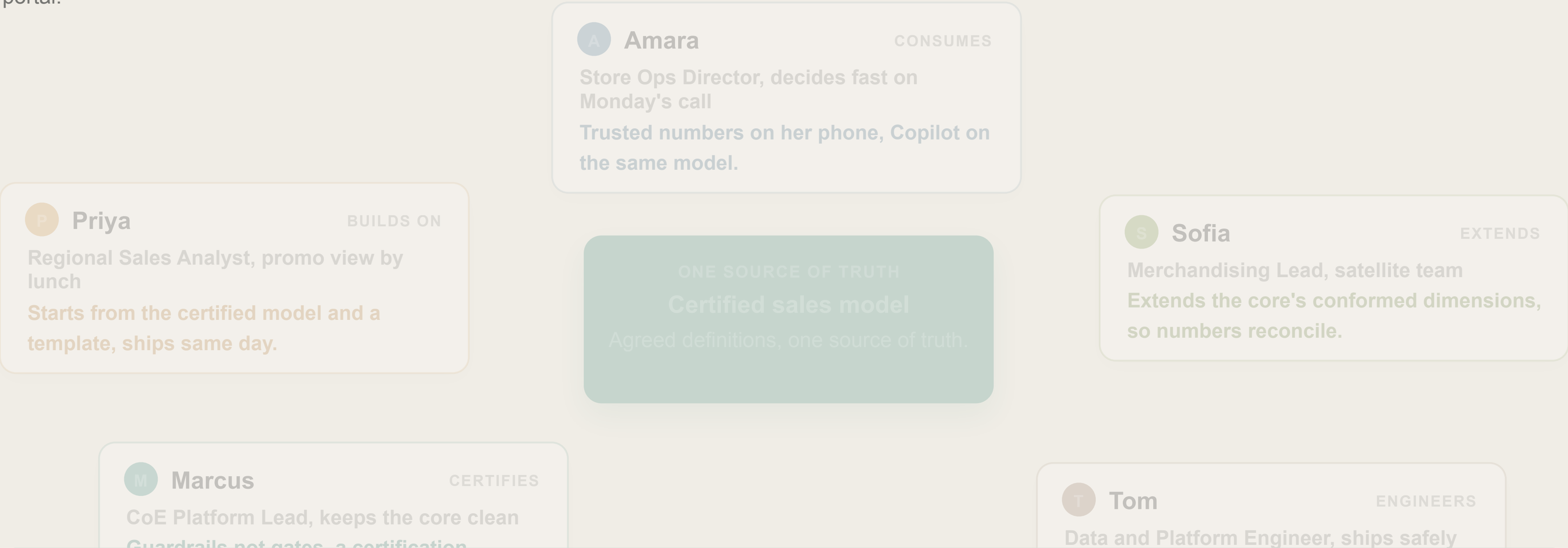
One model, five people: Contoso Retail

About 400 stores plus online. CoE running a year: one certified sales model, medallion Lakehouse, deployment pipelines, a Data@Contoso portal.



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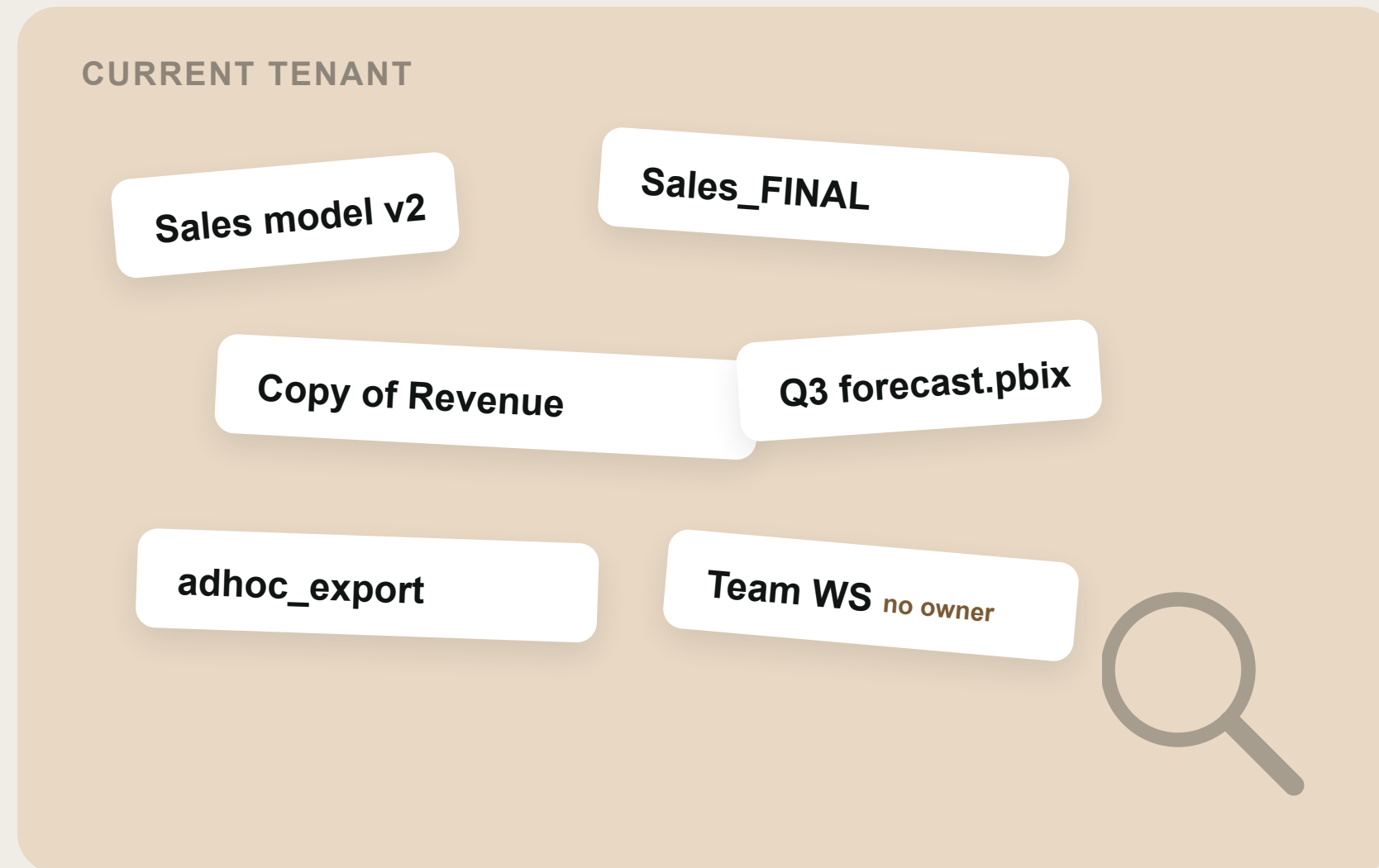


Takeaway: no one here is fighting the governance. Amara trusts, Priya ships, Sofia extends, because Marcus and Tom keep the core disciplined.

BEFORE THE FOUNDATIONS

Before you touch anything, take stock.

Most CoEs start on a messy tenant, not a blank one.



MAKE AN INVENTORY

- **What's trusted**
The models people already rely on.
- **What's sprawl**
Duplicates and near-identical copies.
- **What's shadow**
Content built outside any governance.
- **Who owns what**
Every workspace with a named owner.

Takeaway: you can't design structure, or decide what to certify, until you know what you're standing on.

Five foundations

- 01 **Structure**
- 02 **Trust**
- 03 **Discipline**
- 04 **Policies that scale safely**
- 05 **Self-service**

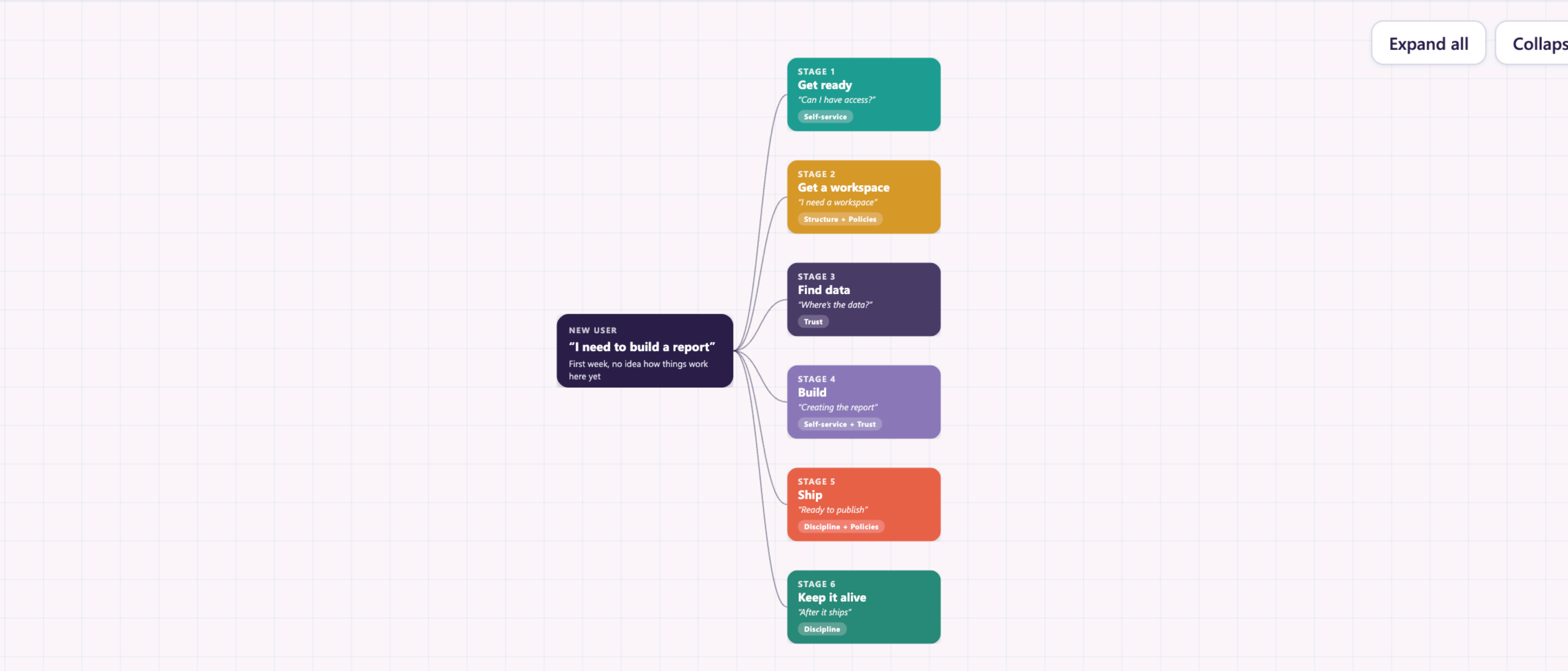
Structure, Trust and Discipline are the core. Policies and Self-service are the edge.

A new user's journey in a CoE-enabled organisation

A new user joins and needs to create a report. At each step the CoE has already set the rules, so they always know what to do next.

- 1 · Get ready (Self-service)
- 2 · Get a workspace (Structure + Policies)
- 3 · Find data (Trust)
- 4 · Build (Self-service + Trust)
- 5 · Ship (Discipline + Policies)
- 6 · Keep it alive (Discipline)

Drag to move around, scroll or pinch to zoom, click a stage to expand or collapse it. Use the buttons to expand all, collapse all, or fit the whole map on screen.



Five foundations

- 01 **Structure**
- 02 **Trust**
- 03 **Discipline**
- 04 **Policies that scale safely**
- 05 **Self-service**

Structure, Trust and Discipline are the core. Policies and Self-service are the edge.

Structure is not one decision, it's a stack at different places

T Tom ring-fences production capacity, so an experiment can't starve the refresh.

01 Tenant

The boundaries everyone lives inside

where structure meets policy



02 Capacity

Does the structure perform



03 Workspace

How the estate is organised



04 Items and naming

Can people find things

Takeaway: structure isn't the workspace diagram; it's a stack from tenant to item

How many customers do you have?

ALL SIGN-UPS

5,109

ACTIVE THIS QUARTER

3,864

NOT YET CLOSED

4,812

Three answers. None of them wrong. **That's the problem.**

FOUNDATION 2: TRUST

Not by picking the right number, by agreeing on one.

M Marcus rejects a model that redefines the measure its own way. Certification is the standard he holds.

01

Define it

Master data: one owned definition.

02

Put it somewhere trustworthy

A certified semantic model every report inherits.

03

Mark it

Endorsement: the certified badge.

04

Defend it

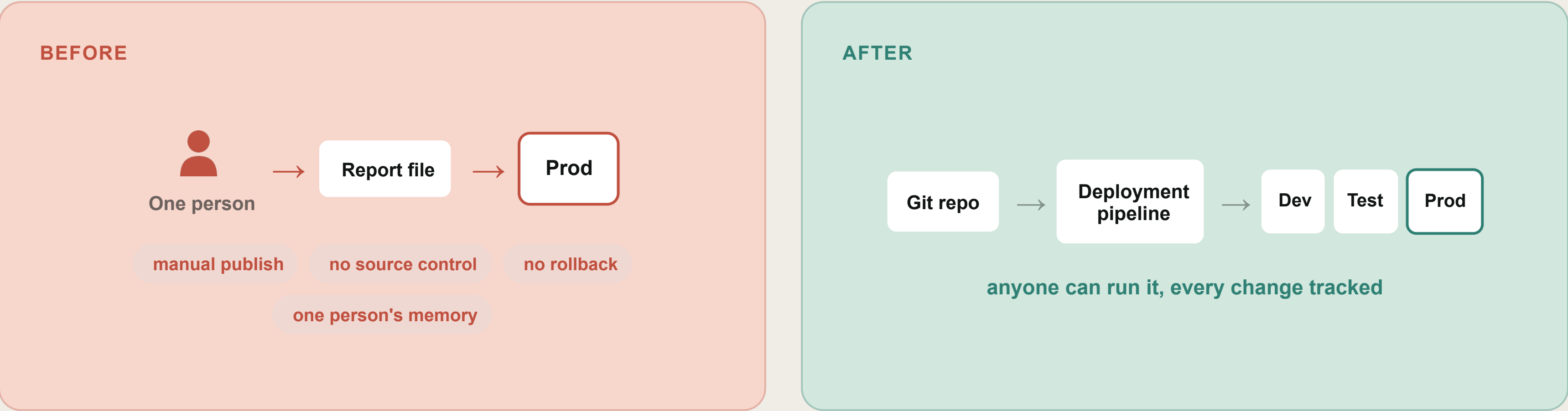
A standard, and a named authority.

IN FABRIC Certified semantic model, endorsement, reviewer groups and sensitivity labels, all in the OneLake catalog.

Takeaway: define the number once, put it somewhere trustworthy, mark it so people find it, and defend it when someone drifts.

Every release ran through one person's memory.

T Tom ships through dev, test and prod. No manual publish, no 9pm heroics.

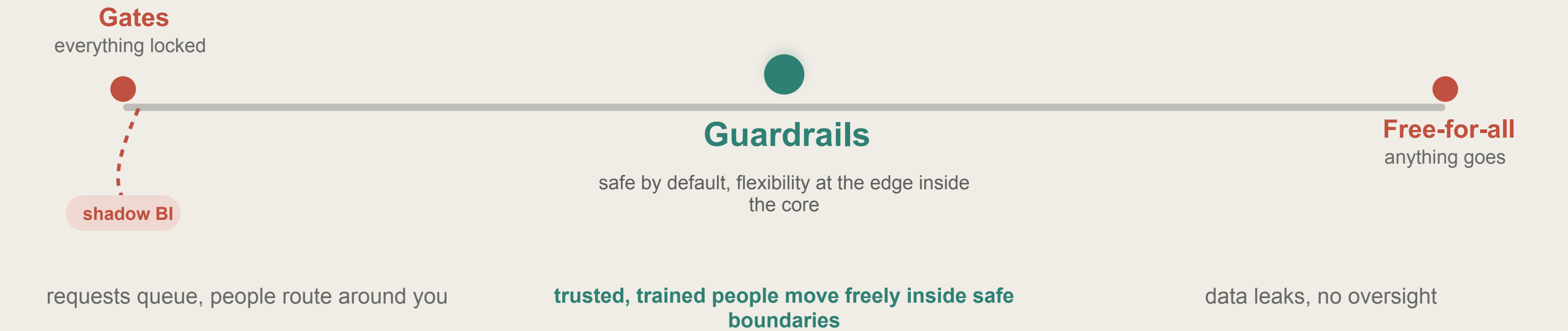


IN FABRIC PBIP/TMDL in git, workspace git integration, deployment pipelines and fabric-cicd, with Best Practice Analyzer checks and the activity log as the audit trail.

Takeaway: if safe deployment depends on one person remembering the steps, that is a single point of failure.

Policies that set sensible boundaries.

M Marcus maintains the guardrails and the standard behind them.

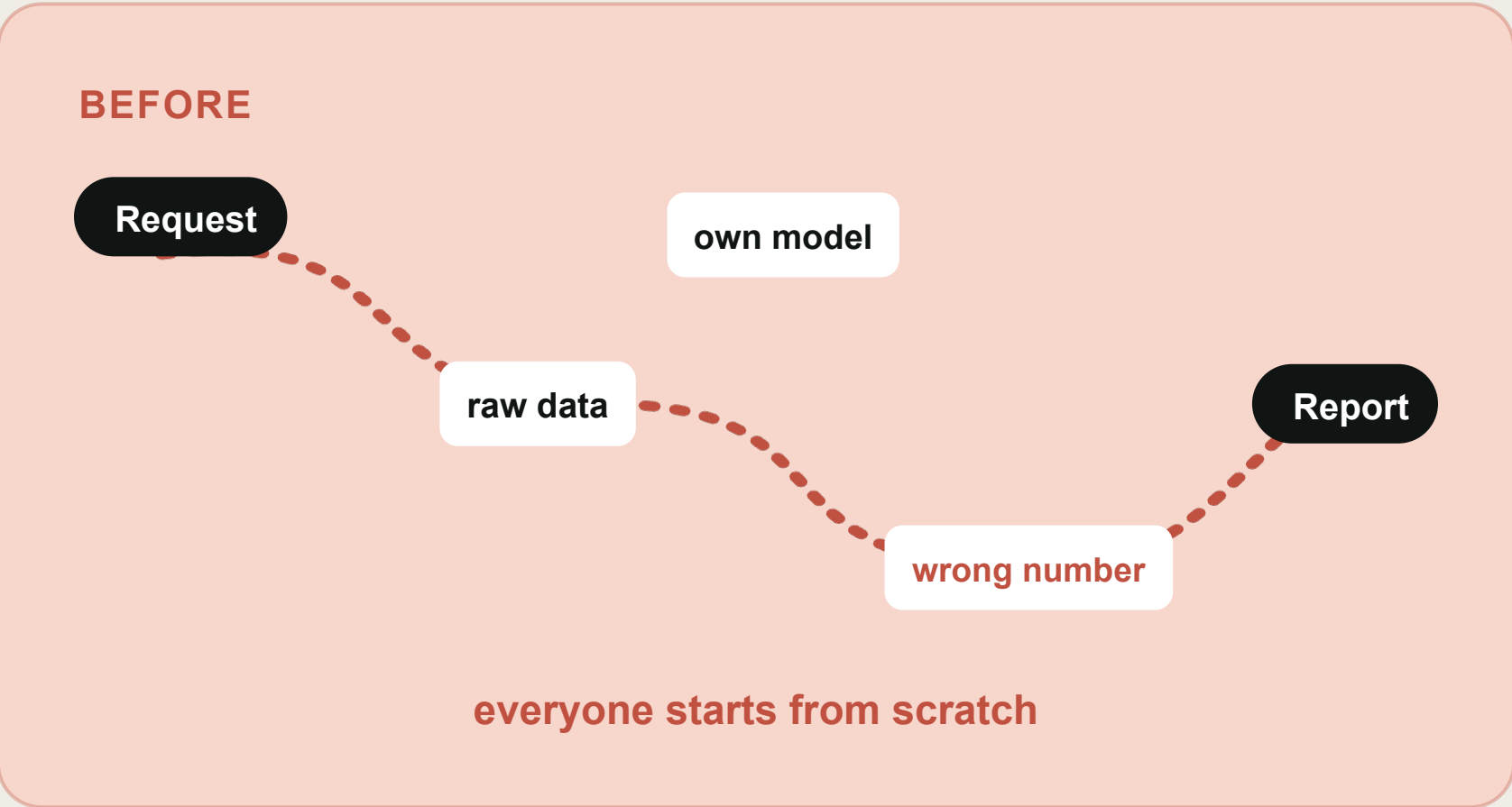


IN FABRIC Tenant settings set deliberately, workspace access reviews on least privilege, OneLake security, and sensitivity labels with DLP in Purview.

Takeaway: when policies block people, they find ways around them. Sensible boundaries keep them on the supported path.

The paved road.

P Priya starts from the certified model and a template, and ships by lunch.



And a way to learn it: office hours, a Teams channel, user groups, hands-on training.

IN FABRIC Live connection to certified semantic models, org report templates and themes, and the OneLake catalog, Explore tab to discover trusted data.

Takeaway: when the supported path is the easiest one, people use it and shadow BI fades.

The regulated lens

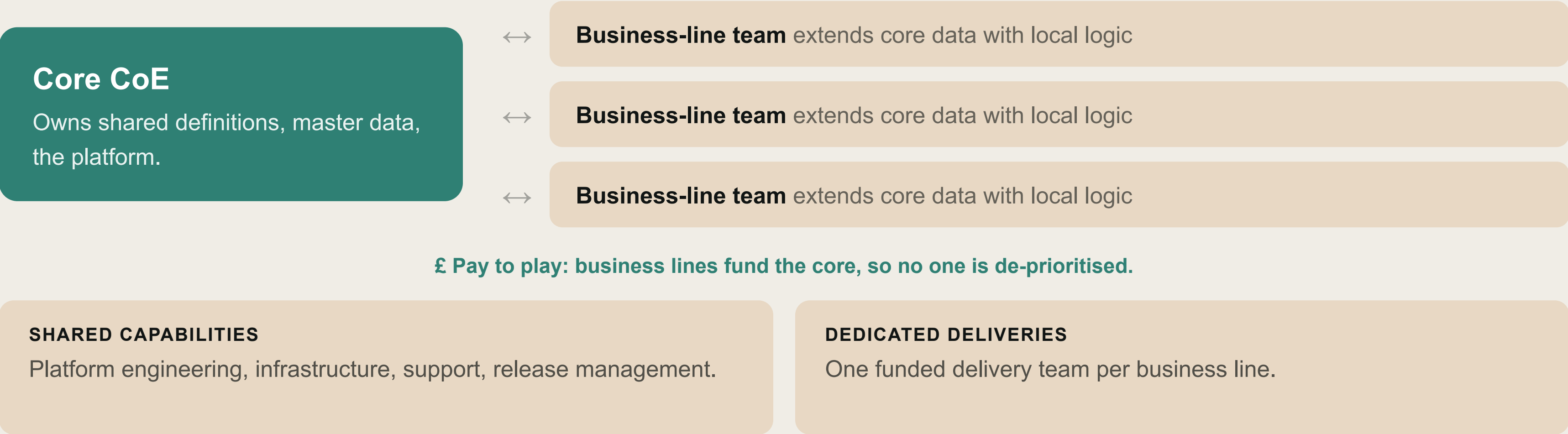
- Audit
- Least privilege
- Data residency and sensitivity

In a bank, you need both freedom and assurance.

Governance doesn't stick without a senior sponsor.

- A senior sponsor with real authority owns the vision and unblocks it.
- The data strategy has to track the business strategy, or the CoE drifts into governance for its own sake.

How a CoE scales without becoming the bottleneck.



Takeaway: the core owns the shared platform, the business lines build on top of it, and shared funding keeps it fair as it grows.

First 90 days

The three moves that pay off first.

The first three moves

Days 0 to 30

Structure and ownership

Workspace topology, capacity model, who owns what.

Days 30 to 60

Define trust

A real certification standard, your first certified and master datasets, sensitivity labels.

Days 60 to 90

Make delivery repeatable

Source control and one deployment pipeline for a flagship solution, then publish it as the pattern.

A working CoE shows up in how people actually work.

Signals of a CoE that's working

- Certified content used over ad-hoc copies
- Time from request to trusted report shrinking
- Fewer duplicate and competing datasets
- Fewer "which number is right" escalations
- Business teams asking to onboard, not being chased

Governance is what makes you AI-ready.

Copilot and Fabric data agents

↑ builds on

Semantic model

agreed definitions, sensitivity labels, least privilege

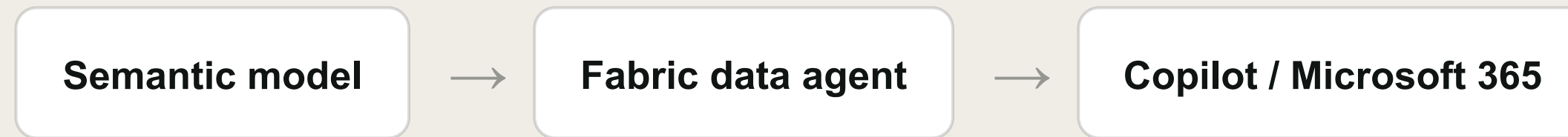
↑ builds on

Governed data

AI is only as trustworthy as the data beneath it.

Takeaway: if the data underneath is a mess, AI gives you wrong answers that look convincing. It runs on your certified models and definitions.

Turning AI on, safely.



Least privilege and sensitivity labels flow through into every answer.

- Consumed through Copilot Studio, agent responses may be processed or stored outside Fabric's compliance boundary or region. For a bank, that is a residency and governance decision, not a default.

Takeaway: the controls that make your reports trustworthy are what let you turn AI on safely.

**Governance is what lets analytics
scale safely.**

**You don't need a finished rulebook to begin, just the first
few moves.**

Thank you

Questions?

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London Microsoft Fabric User Group

References:

Microsoft CoE and adoption guidance

Fabric adoption roadmap: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/guidance/fabric-adoption-roadmap>

Microsoft's BI transformation (discipline at the core): <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/guidance/center-of-excellence-microsoft-business-intelligence-transformation>

Establish a Centre of Excellence: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/guidance/center-of-excellence-establish>

CoE solution architecture: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/guidance/center-of-excellence-business-intelligence-solution-architecture>

Fabric governance features

OneLake catalog overview: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/governance/onelake-catalog-overview>

Govern tab: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/governance/onelake-catalog-govern>

Explore tab: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/governance/onelake-catalog-explore>